negotiator who spent many days with the Chinese in trade negotiations had this to say: 'In the end what mattered more than logic, facts or force of argument was that, as the negotiations had begun, the US delegation placed the "loaded gun" of trade retaliation on the table and pointed to it occasionally . . .' [8] The option of ending a negotiation without a result should, therefore, always be available to the Indian negotiator. The threat of walking out of the talks should be used only when the state of play is overwhelmingly to India's advantage.

The other Chinese play is to fall back on the power of silence. This is a particularly dangerous weapon in the Chinese negotiating arsenal to which the Indian side has succumbed many times. If there is no response from the Chinese side to an Indian proposal or contention, it would be fatal to presume China's acquiescence or acceptance of the idea. China uses the power of silence in two instances—if it wants to keep its real intentions hidden or if it wants to avoid taking a position. This is grand deception. At any subsequent time, the Chinese can reverse course, and they have done so on many issues of importance to India, including the boundary question and India's sovereignty over Jammu and Kashmir. It is critical that the Indian interlocutor not only should not presume that China's silence is tantamount to acceptance of the proposal, but it should also sound the alarm because China might be playing the deception game. Therefore, the Indian interlocutor must also reiterate the Indian proposal more than once for the record in order to make it clear to the Chinese side that it has not fallen for the Chinese trick of silence.

Incidentally, by contrast, any Chinese statement or proposal that has not explicitly been refuted by the other side will be considered by the Chinese side as having been accepted or acknowledged by the Indian side. Therefore, not explicitly